JOHN LEONARD

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Product, Platform & Data Executive specializing in strategy and transformation of **multi-product SaaS portfolios** during high-growth, post-acquisition, or operationally complex environments- across enterprise, private equity-backed, public, and founder-led organizations.

Known for unifying fragmented platforms and building structured operating models that stabilize delivery and scale execution. Success in converting product / data into monetizable assets via analytics, AI, and emerging technologies:

- Contributed to **2 acquisitions (>$200M each)**, 3 profitable exits, and multiple early-stage business launches through product differentiation and operational execution.
- Repeatedly selected to stabilize up to **$75M ARR** and reduce operational risk following 3 acquisitions during periods of growth and transformation.
- Scaled global teams (**30 Product/PMO/UX/Data/Scrum; 100+ Dev/QA/PM**), driving cross-functional alignment and capacity-based delivery prioritization.
- Owned multiple product portfolio roadmaps, evangelism, and lifecycle management at once. The latest span was **5 platforms** with 20 product suites serving **500K+ users** and managing **14TB+ data**.
- Led GTM and customer experience research, ideation, and **0-1 product incubation across 5 startups**, 2 GovTech product-led business models, and co-authored **4 patents**.

Consistent track record **rapidly entering new complex domains** and applying proven product and data operating models for successful business outcomes. Past exposure spans GovTech, procurement, CLM, data warehousing and integrations, intellectual property (patents) commercialization, marketplaces, background screening, content aggregation, training, permitting, GIS, and fintech-adjacent platforms.

EXPERIENCE

Director of Product Operations & Data Practice — 2024 – Feb 2026

SOVRA (PE: KKR, **acquired mdf Commerce**)

SaaS GovTech | HQ: Montreal - OF: Austin (Remote) | $100M Total Revenue

Team of 30: PMO, Product Owners, UX/UI, Data Platform, Scrum Masters, Tech Writing

- *Scale & Transform*: Retained post-acquisition and elevated role to define and operationalize platform and product strategy across a multi-product SaaS portfolio, **leading a 2-year**, **$10M capital improvement** program spanning **50+ initiatives**.
- Standardized roadmap governance and delivery across **5 platforms (20+ products) serving 500K users**, aligning engineering capacity and release sequencing while enabling new GenAI-driven product and operations initiatives.
- Established the company's **first Tech PMO** to scale and speed portfolio delivery, onboarding **100+ offshore** contributors and aligning execution with executive priorities, AI strategy, and customer commitments.
- Architected new market strategy for the lakehouse data platform: unifying **14TB of product and user data** to enable analytics, AI-driven capabilities, product & customer value propositions, and future data monetization opportunities.
- Maintained stability across a **$75M ARR legacy customer base**, positioning the portfolio for future M&A and accelerated PE-backed growth.
- Role concluded following company workforce reduction.

Director of Product Delivery 2021 – 2024

mdf COMMERCE (TSX:MDF, **acquired Periscope**)

SaaS Procurement | HQ: Montreal - OF: Austin (Remote)

Team of 16: Product Owners, Data Platform, Tech Writing

- *Integrate & Operationalize*: Retained post-acquisition and expanded role to transition platform and product strategy into public-company governance: integrating multi-platform product roadmaps, aligning two SaaS business models, and unifying platform capabilities across mid-market, enterprise, and consumer-adjacent offerings.
- Aligned feature prioritization, executive & customer stakeholders, and delivery methodology across a newly integrated **90-person technology organization and 12 acquired products**. **Reduced SLA timelines by 50%**.
- Led product consolidation and **50K customers' migration** of overlapping product line, **preserving $5M ARR**; delivered portfolio feature integrations that opened a new mid-market segment and drove enterprise customer adoption.
- Established mdf's **first Procurement Intelligence data practice**, introducing **65 performance metrics** and portfolio-level analytics to support executive planning, customer behavior insights, and post-acquisition integration strategy.

Director of Product 2018 – 2021

PERISCOPE HOLDINGS, INC (PE: Parthenon Capital)

SaaS Government Procurement | HQ: Austin | $30M ARR | 250K Users

Team of 5: Product Managers, Product Owners, UX/UI, Tech Writing

- *Growth & Exit*: Recruited to turn around product release velocity for a 20+ year-old legacy platform that had not launched a new market-position in eight years; implement new product roadmap governance structure and drive board-aligned prioritization for growth and exit readiness.
- Owned the design, launch, and go-to-market of 3 products and monetization business models: a transaction-based platform (*Reconciler*) supporting $5M ARR and enabling **$18M in new customer revenue;** an aggregate portal (*Supplier-to-Gov*) rebuild that **expanded subscriptions +17%**; and a government industry-first enterprise contract-sharing **platform built in nine months** (*Marketplace*).
- Introduced capacity-driven development forecasting and KPI governance, **increasing Dev/QA output by 44%** while sustaining **three consecutive years of on-time releases**.
- Supported the company's **$200M acquisition** through newly launched product assets and measurable improvements in team performance.

Founder & Fractional Product Leader 2018

ROADMAPVENTURE.COM (Private)

Early-Stage SaaS Advisory | HQ: Austin

- *Consult & Build*: Founded a product advisory practice helping early-stage SaaS companies resolve execution challenges including misaligned product strategy, distributed engineering coordination, and undisciplined Agile delivery.
- Directed product strategy, roadmap development, and **launch execution for 2 startups**: a B2C ML-enabled mobile SaaS platform (*Solcharge*) and a B2B intellectual property and patent intelligence platform (*Techson IP*), which continued post-engagement as a sustainable small business.

Interim Manager, Product & Development 2017 – 2018

DEVERUS, INC. (Private)

SaaS Background Screening | HQ: Austin | 43K Business Customers | 4.1M Annual Hires

Team of 21: Dev/QA, Product Owners, UX/UI

- *Streamline & Modernize*: Recruited to stabilize an underperforming product portfolio and development organization, restructure delivery operations, and expand to a **global dev team from 10 to 21**.
- Delivered **3 platform modernizations within 3 months**: transitioned a 15+ year-old legacy platform to API-driven architecture, replaced a custom integration platform supporting 40 HRIS vendors with MuleSoft, and launched a mobile quick-hire application for gig workforce onboarding—delivered **$90K under budget**.

Chief Technology Officer (Platform Strategy & Integration) 2016 – 2017

DOMINION-HARBOR GROUP (Private; **acquired *idealAsset***)

IP Commercialization & Enforcement | HQ: Dallas - OF: Austin (Remote)

- *Integrate & Operationalize*: Retained following acquisition of *idealAsset* to integrate the platform into patent licensing and enforcement operations.
- Unified technology, product design, and workflow systems while advancing *IPedia*, the firm's first internal software platform supporting patent data analysis, portfolio valuation, and commercialization workflows.

Co-Founder & Vice President, Products 2008 – 2016

FLUID INNOVATION (Angel-backed)

Early-Stage Venture Studio | HQ: Austin | $1.5M Initial Capital

- *Innovate & Build*: Designed, built, and launched **5 startup ventures** with repeatable enterprise and consumer SaaS products across intellectual property commercialization, semantic search, franchising, and consumer banking markets.
- Led product vision, business model design, and global engineering operations; authored **9 patent filings**, co-inventor of **4 issued patents**.
- Delivered **3 successful SaaS venture outcomes**: *IP Zone* (commercialization workflow acquired by AMEX), ***idealAsset*** (IP marketplace acquired by Dominion Harbor), and *Enlyton* (a pre-AI semantic research engine later integrated into IBM Watson partner solutions).

Experience prior to 2008, which includes Management Consulting for Business Intelligence and Geographic Information Systems (GIS) development at GeoAnalytics and the City of Kansas City, Missouri, is available upon request.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

NORTHWEST MISSOURI STATE UNIVERSITY, Maryville, MO

Bachelor of Science, Geography (GIS Emphasis)

Minor, Geology

Pragmatic Marketing Certified (PMC)